Dan Brodkin

Updated November 2, 2026

Email: dbrodkin@sas.upenn.edu **Citizenship**: USA, Canada

Research — Syntax; Prosody; Extended Projection; A-Ā Divide; Structure of the PF Branch

Employment

University of Pennsylvania — Philadelphia, Pennsylvania
Postdoctoral Fellow in Syntax — September 2025 – Present

Education

University of California, Santa Cruz — Santa Cruz, California
PhD in Linguistics — September 2018 – August 2025
Advisor: Sandra Chung

Carleton College — Northfield, Minnesota
BA in Linguistics; BA in History — September 2014 – June 2018

Scholarships

Graduate Research Fellowship (National Science Foundation)	2018 – 2023
Predoctoral Fellowship (University of California, Santa Cruz)	2018 – 2024
Fulbright Research Fellowship (US Department of State)	2018 – 2019
Critical Language Enhancement Award (US Department of State)	2018
Critical Language Scholarship (US Department of State)	2017

Journal Publications

Submitted

Ellipsis, Exponence, and Output Optimization

Reinforcer Postposing Revised:
Linearization and Exponence at the Syntax-Phonology Interface

Resubmitted

Covert Movement, Chain Reduction, and Prosodic Grouping Effects

Under Revision

Subject Positions, High Absolutives, and Austronesian Voice

Pseudopassives, Pied-Piping, and A-Movement of PPs

Accepted with Revisions

The Prosody of Paths
Syntactic Theory and Research

Explaining the Ban on Ergative Anaphors
Glossa — *First author; with Justin Royer*

To Appear

Demonstratives, Reinforcers, and Movement to the Right
Linguistic Inquiry

2025 **The Prosody of the Extended VP**
Natural Language and Linguistic Theory

Suppletion in Global Perspective
Linguistic Inquiry

2022 **Two Steps to High Absolutive Syntax**
The Journal of East Asian Linguistics

Invited Contributions

2026 **The Phonology of Indonesian**
The International Encyclopedia of Language and Linguistics, Third Edition

2024 **Constraining Subcategory-Sensitive Match Constraints**
Syntax-Prosody in Optimality Theory: Theory and Analyses (Advances in Optimality Theory) *with Nick van Handel and Ben Eischens*

Working Papers

2024 **The Ban on Ergative Anaphors**
Proceedings of WCCFL 39 *with Justin Royer*

2022 **Perception Verb Complements in Mandar**
Syntax and Semantics at Santa Cruz V

Two Steps to High Absolutive Syntax
MA Thesis; UCSC

2021 **Anti-Agreement is Syntactic: Evidence from South Sulawesi**
Proceedings of NELS 51

Second-Position Clitics and Prosodic Recursion
Proceedings of AMP 2020

Object Shift and Agent Extraction in Mandar
Proceedings of AFLA 27

2020 **Pseudoclefts and Parameters in the Pacific**
Syntax and Semantics at Santa Cruz IV

Invited Talks

2026 **Time Travel in the Mandar TP**
Boston Morphology Workshop (EXO-Words IV)

A-Syntax at the Edge
Speaker Series; Georgetown University

2024 **The Prosody of Paths**
Phonological Domains Workshop; UC Berkeley

In Indonesia

2025 **The Importance of Research on the Languages of West Sulawesi**
The University of West Sulawesi, Majene *In Indonesian*

2023 **Poetic Meter in the Languages of Sulawesi**
Bina Nusantara University, Jakarta *In Indonesian*

Challenges in Regional Language Pedagogy
Bina Nusantara University, Jakarta *In Indonesian*

Ellipsis, Minimality, and Movement in Mandar
Atma Jaya Catholic University, Jakarta

Why Generative Linguistics? The View from a Regional Language
The National Institute for Research and Innovation, Makassar; *In Indonesian*

Functional Word Lengthening in Mandar: A Generative Perspective
Hasanuddin University, Makassar *In Indonesian*

2022 **Linguistic Theory at the Frontiers of Cross-Cultural Understanding**
The Language Institute of East Java, Surabaya *In Indonesian*

Universal Grammar in West Sulawesi
Bina Nusantara University, Jakarta *In Indonesian*

Phonological Displacement in Mandar
Atma Jaya Catholic University, Jakarta

2019 **Language Death in Indonesia**
Bina Nusantara University, Jakarta *In Indonesian*

The Linguistic History of Sulawesi
State University of Malang, Malang *In Indonesian*

Conference Talks

2024 **The Prosody of Paths**
AFLA 31; UMass Amherst

Metrical Structure in Mandar Poetry
Kolita 22; Atma Jaya University *with Maria Tamarina Prawati and Jupri Talib*

The Prosody of the Extended VP
Annual Meeting of the Linguistics Society of America

2023 **Rightward Movement in a language of Sulawesi**
AIFIS-MSU Conference on Indonesian Studies *in Indonesian; with Jupri Talib*

2022 **Prosodic Greed in Mandar**
TripleAFLA; University of Manchester

What's a Subject? A Perspective from Sulawesi
AIFIS-MSU Conference on Indonesian Studies *in Indonesian; with Jupri Talib*

2021 **Philippine Voice and Split Absolutive Syntax**
AFLA 28; McGill University

Two Constraints on Ergative Anaphors
AFLA 28; McGill University *with Justin Royer*

Wh-Movement in Mandar
95th Meeting of the LSA; San Francisco

2020 **Object Shift and Agent Extraction in Mandar**
AFLA 27; NUS

2019 **Clitic Placement in the Languages of South Sulawesi**
Kolita 17; Atma Jaya Catholic University, Jakarta

Posters

2026 **What is Ellipsis?**
NELS 57; CUNY Graduate Center

2024 **Height and Locality in Mandar Ā-Extraction**
AFLA 31; UMass Amherst

2022 **Existential Match: Evidence from Mandar**
AMP 2022; UCLA

2021 **Ergative Anaphors and High Absolutive Syntax**
WCCFL 39; University of Arizona, Tucson *with Justin Royer*

2020 **Anti-Agreement is Syntactic: Evidence from South Sulawesi**
NELS 51; UQAM

Second Position and Prosodic Recursion
AMP 2020; UC Santa Cruz

Reading Group Talks

2026 **Syntax Brown Bag**; New York University
Syntax Workshop; University of Massachusetts, Amherst
S-Lab; University of Maryland, College Park
Syntax Reading Group; Yale University

2025 **Syntax Reading Group**; Yale University

2023 **Syntax Reading Group**; Yale University
Smircle; Stanford University

2022 **Syntax Brown Bag**; New York University

2021 **Syntax and Semantics Circle**; UC Berkeley

2020 **Fieldwork Lab**; McGill University

2019 **Syntax Reading Group**; National University of Singapore

Teaching at UCSC

Ling 112: Syntax 1
Fall 2024 Teaching assistant; with Roumyana Pancheva
Fall 2020 Teaching assistant; with Jorge Hankamer

Ling 50: Intro to Linguistics
Spring 2025 Teaching assistant; with Grant McGuire
Winter 2025 Teaching assistant; with Andrew Angeles

Spring 2024 **Ling 80K: Invented Languages**
Teaching assistant; with Andrew Angeles

Fall 2021 **Ling 53: Semantics 1**
Teaching assistant; with Maziar Toosarvandani

Service

AMERICA

Reviewer, Oxford Handbook of Clitics 2026
Reviewer, Journal of East Asian Linguistics 2026
Reviewer, Journal of Linguistics 2026

Reviewer, Natural Language & Linguistic Theory 2024, 2025, 2026
Reviewer, Oceanic Linguistics 2021

INDONESIA

Praat Workshops
Bina Nusantara University 2024
The National Research and Innovation Agency 2023
The Language Office of South Sulawesi 2022

Undergraduate Syntax. Guest Lecturer.
Department of English, Bina Nusantara University 2023

Generative Grammar. Guest Lecturer.
Department of Linguistics, Atma Jaya Catholic University 2019

Advising

External PhD Thesis Committee Member
Siti Mafulah
"Exploring student engagement with corrective feedback in EFL classrooms."
State University of Malang, Faculty of Literature 2022

External Undergraduate Thesis Committee Member
Jupri Talib
"An Analysis of Rhyme and Rhythm in the Mandar Poetry of West Sulawesi"
Kanjuruhan University of Malang, Faculty of Letters 2022

Coordinated Reading Groups

Syntax Lab
University of Pennsylvania 2025 – Present

The Morphology Reading Group (MRG)
UC Santa Cruz 2020 – 2023

The Syntax-Prosody Reading Group
Zoom: UCSC; McGill; MIT; NUS; Lund 2020 – 2021

Labeling Out of Control
Zoom: UCSC; NYU; University of Chicago 2020 – 2021

Undergraduate Syntax Club
UC Santa Cruz 2020 – 2023

Languages

Native: English
Professional: Indonesian
Conversational: Javanese, Mandar, French
Other: LaTeX, Praat, FLEx, Python, German, Spanish, Greek (Ancient/Medieval)